

SPACE TO MAKE

Makerspaces that promise easy, affordable access to hobbyists and aspiring hardware entrepreneurs are springing up around the country. Is India ready for the anti-school?

In May, Sanjiv Valsan, Vishwaraj Doshi and Rujai Mehta — third year engineering students from DJ Sanghvi College of Engineering, Mumbai decided to build a formula style racing car. The dream was big and the team sizeable — 30 students across eight departments signed up to help. The car that was to be designed, built and tested, and would go on to compete in an international design competition to be held in Hockenheim, Germany.

Valsan and team had a winning idea. They decided to use a motorcycle engine in the car. This meant all corresponding parts needed to be built from scratch since they could not be sourced from existing cars. When it came to manufacturing the parts however, there was just one problem — they didn't know where to start. That's when he decided to approach Maker's Asylum, a makerspace in Mumbai, for help. Here, they were able to access 3D printers to print plastic moulds of any and all parts they may